IWAE FIELD GUIDE / 2026

From Evidence to Insight

A practical workflow for turning source material into connected, reviewable knowledge without losing its origin.

READ

Inspect the source at full fidelity.

CAPTURE

Lift only the evidence you need.

CONNECT

Arrange claims into a visible argument.

The core promise

Every idea remains inspectable: you can see what it means, where it came from, and how it supports the work around it.

A Reading Workflow

01

Orient

Scan the outline, identify the author's purpose, and mark the section that answers your current question.

02

Capture

Select the smallest passage that still contains the claim, its qualifier, and the words needed to interpret it.

03

Connect

Place the excerpt near related evidence, then add a short note that states why the relationship matters.

04

Verify

Return to the source before publishing. Confirm wording, page location, and whether later evidence changes the claim.

Capture Meaningful Evidence

Capture only enough material to preserve meaning; the smallest useful excerpt is easier to compare and reuse.

Selection quality test

Read the excerpt without looking at the page. If the subject, claim, or limiting condition becomes ambiguous, expand the selection by one sentence and test again.

Good evidence is concise, but never context-free.

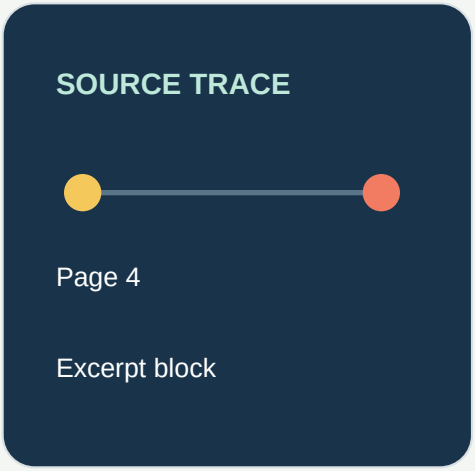
SIGNAL	TOO LITTLE	USEFUL CAPTURE
Claim	Result only	Result plus subject
Constraint	Number only	Number plus condition
Definition	Term only	Term plus defining sentence
Exception	Warning only	Rule plus exception

Keep Context Attached

An excerpt is valuable because it can be checked. A source link should survive movement, resizing, translation, and visual rearrangement.

A durable source anchor stores

- Document identity
- Page and selected geometry
- Exact quoted text
- Text before and after the quote



Trust rule

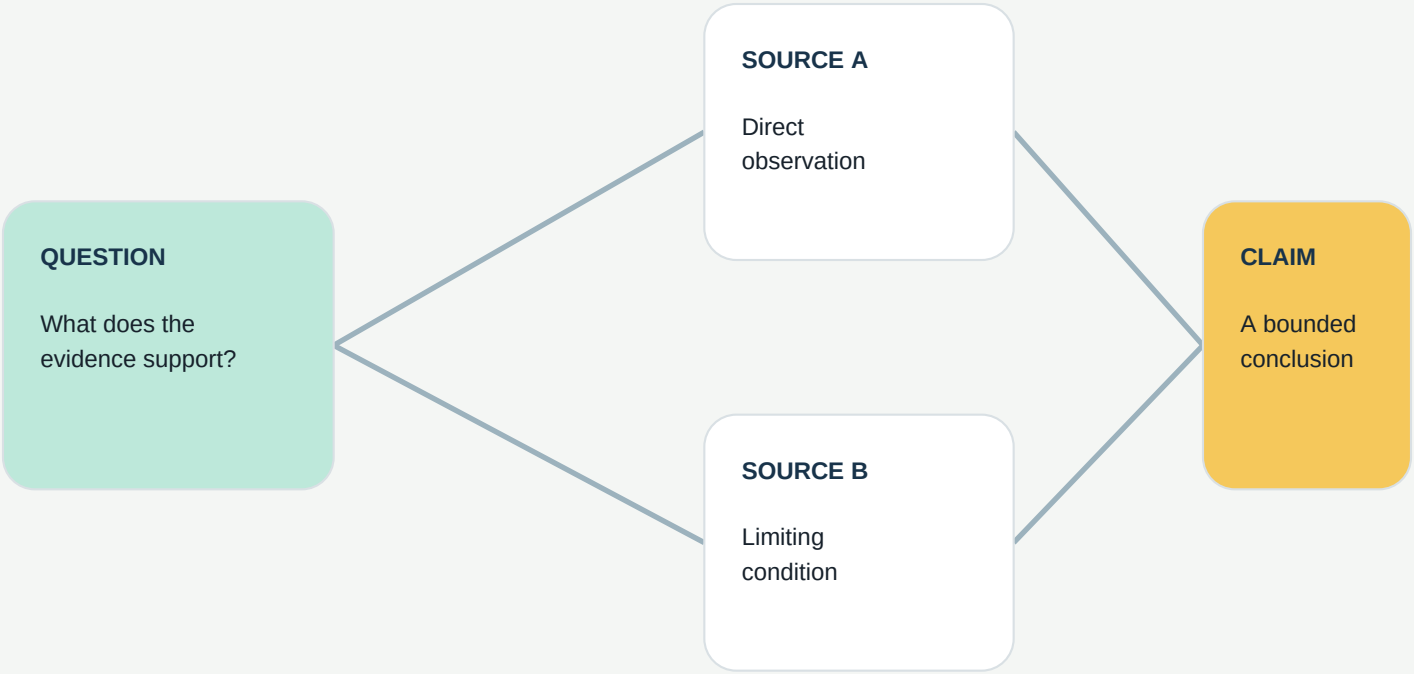
Keep source identity, page location, selected geometry, and quoted text together. If one part changes, the link should be treated as stale rather than silently trusted.

Review cue

When a source moves, show uncertainty. Never repair a citation by guessing silently.

Synthesize on the Canvas

Spatial arrangement turns a list of quotations into an argument you can inspect.



A SMALL, EXPLICIT NOTE IS ENOUGH

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question  ->  evidence

evidence  ->  interpretation

interpretation  ->  reviewable claim
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Use proximity for grouping and visible connectors for claims that must remain explicit.

Review Checklist

Before a note becomes a decision, draft, or published explanation, test whether another reader can retrace the reasoning.

OK

SOURCE

Can every excerpt return to its document and page?

OK

CONTEXT

Does each capture include the qualifier that changes its meaning?

OK

STRUCTURE

Can the reader tell which evidence supports, limits, or contradicts the claim?

OK

LANGUAGE

Are your own words visually distinct from quoted material?

OK

REVIEW

Did you revisit the original source after arranging the final argument?

Evidence is useful when it remains understandable, connected, and verifiable.